Newton Guidelines for the Use of Generative AI: Data and Student Privacy Passages

Excerpted verbatim from *Guidelines for the Use of Generative AI in the Newton Public Schools (Department of Information Technology & Library Services, Newton Public Schools, Massachusetts, updated July 2025)*. Page numbers refer to the PDF pages of the source file. Ellipses (…) mark omitted text. The document has no printed page numbers, so PDF page numbers are used.

Introduction (excerpt)

Source: PDF page 1

These guidelines have been developed to inform the use of Generative AI systems by staff and students in the Newton Public Schools. It addresses concerns of data privacy, terms of service, and academic honesty.

Guiding Principles: Protecting Data Privacy and Online Safety

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Protecting Data Privacy and Online Safety - Many AI tools, particularly those not built for educational settings, lack data privacy agreements with Newton Public Schools. Only enter Personally Identifiable Information (PII) into systems that have such agreements. This isn't just best practice for school-related information, but also for your personal use of AI. Furthermore, please be aware that AI tools can generate inaccurate, biased, or inappropriate content for students and the educational environment. Therefore, thoughtful guidance and informed use of AI are essential.

Generative AI Use by NPS Staff: Data Protection

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- Generative AI tools incorporated into systems (such as Brisk) for which NPS has signed Data Privacy Agreements can be fed personally identifiable data. Check to make sure the tools are listed in the NPS Student Data Privacy Agreement Database.
- Generative AI tools NOT included or listed in the NPS Student Data Privacy Agreement Database (such as ChaptGPT) can be used by staff so long as personally identifiable information is not shared with the system. This includes but is not limited to:
- Do NOT use student names, ID numbers, or other identifiers.
- Do NOT share or paste text into such systems that include student or staff personally identifiable information.
- Do NOT share sensitive data such as social security numbers, grades, medical information, or discipline information with Generative AI systems.

Generative AI Use by NPS Students: Online Responsible Use Best Practices (excerpt)

Source: PDF page 6

- **Protect your Data:** When using any online tool, including AI, be cautious with what you share. Avoid sharing personal information except when necessary and only after understanding a tool's privacy policy (ie., how is the data you enter into the system used by the system, is the system "selling" your data to other parties, etc.)
- **Develop AI Literacy:** Understand the limitations and appropriate use cases of AI; evaluate AI content for bias and factual accuracy; understand how AI systems process data and produce results; think critically about ethical issues such as how AI systems are trained, what the systems do with user data, and environmental impacts.